

JUNIOR ECOLOGIST SERIES

Overview

The Junior Ecologist Workshop Series invites young learners to explore ecology, plant biology, animal care, and environmental stewardship through hands-on field science and interactive technology. Participants investigate soil ecosystems under digital microscopes, care for farm animals, learn about native California plants and wildlife, and create permanent community art. To synthesize their research, participants use Wild Byte's kid-friendly story building software to transform their field notes and photos into interactive digital presentations shared with family and friends at graduation.

By the end of the series, Junior Ecologists will be able to:

1. Identify key native and invasive plant species using botanical classification tools and field guides.
2. Trace energy flow, food webs, and predator-prey dynamics within local ecosystems.
3. Analyze soil composition, texture, and nutrient cycles supporting plant life and microbial life.
4. Apply field research methods to local environmental stewardship, habitat creation, and community science.

Pricing

- Standard registration: \$195 per child
- Sibling discount: \$75 for each additional child
- Registration covers ALL supplies and materials for the entire series! Every participant will receive an official Junior Ecologist t-shirt, field notebook & pencil, gardening kit, and certificate of completion.
- At Wild Byte, our mission is to make learning accessible to everyone. A limited number of financial scholarships are available. Please reach out to us at contact@wildbyte.dev to discuss financial assistance options.
- Children ages 5 and under are welcome to join free of charge when accompanied by a parent or guardian. While activity materials are reserved for registered participants, young children are encouraged to participate alongside their family.

Liability & Waiver Forms

To ensure the safety and well-being of all participants, a completed liability and participation form is required for each child prior to the start of the first session. You will receive these forms upon registration, and they must be submitted before or at

check-in on Day 1. ***Please note that children cannot participate or remain on site without completed forms on file.***

What to Bring & Dress Code

Because our sessions are interactive and outdoors, please make sure your Junior Ecologist comes prepared:

- Attire: comfortable outdoor clothing that can get dirty, plus sturdy, closed-toe shoes.
- Sun protection: hat, sunglasses, and sunscreen applied prior to arrival.
- Hydration & snacks: a reusable water bottle labeled with your child's name (water refill stations will be available) and a light snack if desired.

Weather Policy & Rescheduling

Our workshops take place outdoors. In the event of severe weather or unsafe conditions (such as heavy rain or extreme heat), sessions may need to be rescheduled for safety.

- Notifications: registered families will receive notification via email/text at least 2 hours prior to class time if a session must be postponed.
- Make-up sessions: rescheduled dates will be announced promptly, or alternative accommodations will be provided.

Parent & Family Involvement

This is a family-friendly workshop series! Parents and guardians are strongly encouraged to stay, participate, and explore alongside their child(ren). Learning together strengthens connection, supports your child's discovery, and makes for a fun shared outdoor experience.

We warmly welcome children of all abilities and are happy to make special accommodations whenever possible to ensure a positive experience for your family. Please reach out in advance with any specific needs at contact@wildbyte.dev. Please note: the garden setting does not feature paved pathways, which may present accessibility limitations for some mobility needs.

Additional Helpful Information

- **Health & Allergy Considerations:** Please notify instructors in advance of any severe allergies (such as bee stings or specific plant sensitivities) or medical considerations so we can accommodate safely.
- **Photo & Media Consent:** Optional photo permission forms will be available at check-in for families who wish to share photos of program activities.
- **Questions & Support:** If you have any questions before the first day, please feel free to reach out to our team at any time.

Agenda

Date	Time	Facilitator	Workshop Week Title	Workshop Week Description
9/26/2026	9-11AM	Angelica Victoria	Week 1 -Introduction to the garden space & microscopic explorations of soil composition.	Enjoy a mindful walk around the Root 66 Community Garden. Perform soil texture tests, and begin field journal recordings.
10/03/2026	9-11AM	Angelica Victoria	Week 2 -California native plants & botanical classification.	Native vs. invasive plant identification, plant adaptations, and harvesting.
10/10/2026	9-11AM	Angelica Victoria	Week 3 -Animal care & ecosystem food webs.	Trace energy flow, levels of food webs, and predator-prey dynamics within local ecosystems.
10/17/2026	9-11AM	Angelica Victoria	Week 4 -Wildlife habitat construction & field research.	Farm animal & wildlife care. Conduct field surveys through observation of native pollinators, reptiles, and beneficial garden insects.
10/24/2026	9-11AM	Angelica Victoria	Week 5 -Environmental art & community legacy.	Paint personalized garden rocks to establish decorative paths in “Kid’s Corner”. Canvas painting.
10/31/2026	9-11AM	Angelica Victoria	Week 6 -Data synthesis & digital storytelling.	Input field data (field notes, microscope snapshots, observations, etc. from Weeks 1-5) into Wild Byte’s story builder to generate digital presentation.
11/07/2026	9-11AM	Angelica Victoria	Week 7 -Showcase, celebration & graduation!	You did it!! Participants present their interactive stories to family and peers. Graduation ceremony!